

October

30

1938 Alien alert

When an adaptation of British writer H G Wells's science-fiction novel *The War of the Worlds* aired on US radio, confused listeners supposedly panicked, fearing that news reports of an alien invasion were true.



Born this day

1960 Diego Maradona, Argentinian footballer. He was named FIFA's Player of the 20th century. His extraordinary technical skill and creativity made him one of history's greatest footballers.



Also on this day

1961 The most explosive nuclear bomb ever, the *Tsar Bomba*, was detonated by the Soviet Union in a test on Severny Island, north of Russia.

1991 At a peace conference in Madrid, Spain, representatives from Israel, Palestine, and the Arab states met those from the USA and the Soviet Union to plan how to achieve peace in the Middle East.

Sunglasses on! 2013

Residents in the town of Rjukan, Norway, celebrated the town's first-ever day of winter sun. Located deep in a valley, Rjukan is in darkness for half the year, so giant mirrors were installed to reflect sunlight down to the town's centre.

